

Negating Quantified Statements

The negation of a statement changes it from true to false, or false to true.

e.g., $\exists x \in \mathbb{Q} : x^2 = 2$, this is false

negation $\rightarrow \forall x \in \mathbb{Q} : x^2 \neq 2$, which is true

When negating a statement, you flip the universal quantifiers, alongside the truth or falsities.

$\neg (\neg \exists) \quad \neg (\neg \forall)$

$= (\exists) \neq$

$\rightarrow$ If P is a proposition, then $\neg(P)$ is its negation

Implication

The implication of one statement because of another is to say that the implied statement follows logically from the previous.

P	Q	$P \Rightarrow Q$
F	F	T
F	T	T
T	F	F
T	T	T

$\rightarrow$ Though it seems illogical, it is very much so true.
In everyday speech, yes it would be different.

$\rightarrow$ Since the statements should follow each other logically, then this must be false

General methods of proofs

• Direct Proofs

simply take you from point A to point B

these are good for statements of the form $\forall x \in S : P(x) \Rightarrow Q(x)$.

let $x \in S$, then assume $P(x)$ is true, and finally deduce that $Q(x)$ is true

• Contrapositive Proof

Essentially, consider the logically equivalent opposite to the original statement and perform a direct proof from there.

$P \Rightarrow Q$ becomes $\neg(Q) \Rightarrow \neg(P)$

This is useful for when the contrapositive of a statement is easier to prove than the original statement.

e.g., $x \notin \mathbb{Q} \Rightarrow \frac{1}{x} \notin \mathbb{Q}$

The contrapositive is $\frac{1}{x} \in \mathbb{Q} \Rightarrow x \in \mathbb{Q}$, which is far easier to prove

• Proof by Contradiction

This is to assume the negation and deduce a contradiction, implying that the original statement is true.

Take the statement P and assume negation which is $\neg(P)$.

You could also say $\neg(P) \Rightarrow F$ from which we can deduce P

These proofs tend to rely more heavily on definitions